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### **Professional Growth Goals**

I want to develop an elementary proficiency in each of the subjects included in the high school technical education curriculum. To be clear, I will not be able to teach myself twelve high school courses as a full-time education student, but I can devote a few hours familiarizing myself with the theory, tools, and processes of each to create a foundation from which I can learn and teach effectively. The reasons for this may seem self-evident, but I think it's worth affirming: for me to be as effective as a teacher, I need to be knowledgeable about what I am teaching. I don't need to know everything, but in order to instruct, guide, and evaluate students, I should have some experience with the material. This is particularly relevant since I was not able to take any tech ed classes in high school so unlike my second teachable, math, my tech ed experience is much more specialized in a subject group that is already broader than most. Fortunately, I have some understanding of a few of the subjects through previous self-study and most have free, open-source tools and active online communities from which I can learn. To achieve this goal, I will first organize my existing resources, fill in gaps where I find them, and create a step-by-step learning pathway that takes advantage of the overlaps in skills. If I set aside time each week to work on building my proficiency, by the end of the program I should feel much more confident in my knowledge and the ability to teach these concepts.

I want to get involved with at least one extracurricular activity related to my practicum placement. Extracurriculars were a key part of my school experience and are something that I would like to incorporate into my teaching career. I am hoping that helping out with one or more clubs or activities during a practicum placement will give me a gradual introduction and allow me to build up the skills and habits to take on a greater degree of responsibility in the future. Doing so will also help me to form relationships with students in a non-academic context and better appreciate their talents and interests, improving my effectiveness as an educator. To do this, I will need to start by putting in the effort to connect with a wide range of staff at my placement, finding out about what extracurriculars are offered and could use some extra help, then ensuring that I am well organized and have enough of a handle on my other responsibilities to commit time before or after school and can show up ready to help. I

will be heavily reliant on my associate teacher as a primary point of contact for information and introductions; assuming other students will be completing their practicums in the same school, I can also look to them for support in getting involved.

I want to set up the means through which I can maintain meaningful, long-term contact with at least one of the supervising teachers on my practicum. I believe in the importance and value of mentorship in any professional career and would like to have the support of someone who is experienced not just with teaching generally, but with my teachable subjects in particular. My main methods for achieving this will be to demonstrate a willingness to learn and put in the effort required to improve my skills as a teacher, practicing recognizing and acknowledging the gaps in my knowledge so that I can ask questions that support my professional development, and expressing an appreciation for the guidance I receive during the placement, seeing feedback as an opportunity for growth and putting suggestions into practice.